

Writing Book Reviews

Planning a Book Review

Purpose: To review a book and inform other readers.

Use this sheet to plan your book review. Use bullet points or short sentences to organise your ideas.

Book Title: _____

Background Information

Begin with a short summary. This section should only be a few sentences and may include:

- Background information about the author, when the book was written and what was happening at the time the book was written. This gives context to the reader.
- A quote that stuck out to you from the book.
- An explanation of an important word or phrase used in the book, to help the reader understand.
- Interesting facts about the author or the book itself.

Information About the Book

This section should be just under half of your review. Include information about things like:

- General Information
- Plot (no spoilers!)
- Characters
- Theme
- Setting

Your Opinion/Analysis

This section should be about half of your review. You could include things like:

- Why would others enjoy this book?
- What did you enjoy or not enjoy about it?
- What age group and type of reader would it be good for?
- Did it engage you emotionally – did you laugh or cry, or think about something in the book for days?
- What did you like or dislike about the writing style? Was it funny? Hard to follow? Engaging? Casual? Formal?
- How well do you think the author achieved what they were trying to do?

- Did the book feel complete or did it feel like it was missing key elements?
- How does it compare to similar books that you have read?

Rating

Give the book a rating. Commonly this is out of 5 or 10.

E.g. I give this book 4/5 stars.